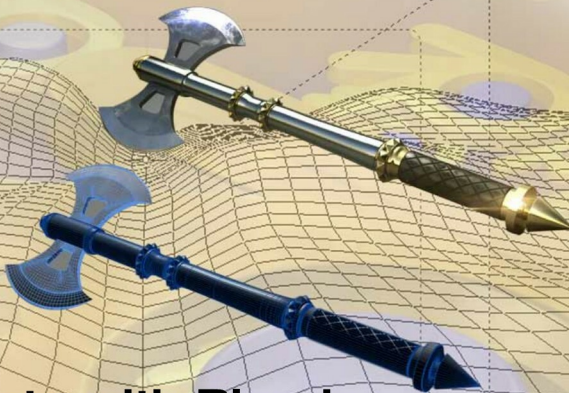




Animate with Blender

Decaling and Rigging the Goldfish

Part—2

This second article in the series on animation with Blender teaches you how to use decaling to show textures on a model and later how to make a working skeleton for the gold fish.

Compared to texturing, decaling is a faster way of showing up textures on a 3D model. Decaling involves first assigning any one type of UV projection to a 3D model, and then applying a pre-made texture to the model. It saves a lot of time, since you just apply the texture rather than take the UV map to a 2D painting program to paint it. On the other hand, decaling may not be handy if you have to texture a complex 3D model like a human body. It is fairly useful on simple bodies, like that of a goldfish.

Working with a split viewport

While decaling, it is always best to open the model, and then split the viewport into two side-by-side viewports. Open the goldfish model. Using the Middle Mouse Button (MMB), click at the top inner border of the default viewport. From the options that appear, choose 'Split Area'. Click and accept the default settings.

Make sure the left view is set to side view (press 3 on the

numeric pad), and ensure it is set to the orthographic view (press 5). Set the right viewport to the UV/Image Editor window (select the option from the drop-down menu at the separator bar). See Figure 1 for an example.

Creating the desired UV projection

To create a UV projection, select the *UV Face Select* mode from the drop-down menu at the separator bar. Type A to select all UV faces. Now, to choose the projection, press U to bring up projection options, and select the *Project From View* option (Figure 2). Once the UV mapping is projected in the UV/Image Editor window, it becomes fairly easy to open the background goldfish image that we had used as a reference for the modelling work (Figure 3).

Applying the decal and making adjustments

Adjust the size and shape of the UV projection to match that of the profile image of the fish that appears in the background